



FAVOURED FEW: Pasricha (extreme left) with home minister R.R. Patil; and Jadhav (right)

government. This umbilical cord that binds the police force and politicians is the root cause of the systemic crisis wherein top level police appointments are ad hoc and not made on merit. The criteria for the coveted chair is clearly spelt out—loyalty and pliability at the hands of powerful politicians.

In times when the once-premier police force is embroiled in controversies like custodial deaths and falsely implicating builders in murder cases, there is a pressing need for a police chief who can reform the system. Referring to the poor law and order situation after Raj Thackeray's party workers went on a rampage, M.N. Singh says, "It was the height of incompetence. Instead of taking action against the offenders, the police leadership waited for directions from politicians." The July 2006 train blasts only exposed the lapses in the intelligence system.

At a recent meeting of the IPS Association in Amravati, senior officers like Meeran Borwankar and A.K.



Sharma moved a resolution saying that IPS members should refrain from seeking or accepting extensions. Many of these officers believe that extensions are unethical because contenders seek political favours and deny other deserving officers a chance. Some day hopefully, politicians too will understand a simple fact like that. ■

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